



TIPS & TRICKS



View the contents of *tar* and *rpm* files

Here are two simple commands to show you the contents of the *tar* and *rpm* files.

1. To view the content of a *tar* file, issue the following command:

```
#tar -tvf /path/to/file.tar
```

2. To view the content of an *rpm* file, use the command given below:

```
#rpm -qlp /path/to/file.rpm
```

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Playing around with MP3 files

Here is a tip that helps you cut, split, join or merge MP3 files in Ubuntu, resulting in a better quality output.

To cut an MP3 file, you need to install *poc-streamer*, as follows:

```
$sudo apt-get install poc-streamer
```

The syntax for *mp3cut* is given below:

```
mp3cut [-o outputfile] [-T title] [-A artist] [-N album-name] [-t [hh:]mm:ss[+ms]-[hh:]mm:ss[+ms]] mp3 [-t ...]  
mp3 -o output: default file, default mp3file.out.mp3
```

For example, if you want to cut a one-minute clip of the MP3 file named *input.mp3* to a .wav file called *output.wav*, run the following command:

```
$mp3cut -o output.wav -t 00:00(+0)-01:00(+0) input.mp3
```

If you want to join two MP3 files, you need to install *mp3wrap*, as follows:

```
$sudo apt-get install mp3wrap
```

The syntax for *mp3wrap* is shown below:

```
$mp3wrap merged_filename.mp3 filename1.mp3 filename2.mp3
```

...where *filename1.mp3* and *filename2.mp3* are my input files that can be merged together.

Finally, you can split a single large MP3 file into small files by installing *Mp3split* using the following command:

```
$sudo apt-get install mp3split
```

Now, to split the large file, run the following command:

```
$mp3split filename.mp3 00.00 01.23 03.20
```

Filename.mp3 is my input file, which can be split into two MP3 files. One is from the start to the 1 min 23 sec point, and another one is from 1 min 23 sec to 3 min 20 sec. *Mp3split* can make smaller files without decoding even the file.

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GRUB 2 recovery

We often come across a condition in which the boot loader gets corrupt. Here are a few steps that will help you recover your GRUB 2 boot loader.

Boot from a live CD or DVD, which supports GRUB 2 (Ubuntu 9.10 CD or above. A DVD will take more time than a CD, so I suggest you boot from a CD).

Open the terminal and run *fdisk -l* to check the partition from which you want to recover GRUB 2.

Here I assume that you want to recover it from */dev/sda1*.

Then run the following commands:

```
$sudo mkdir /media/sda1
```

```
$sudo mount /dev/sda1 /media/sda1
```

```
$sudo mount --bind /dev /media/sda1/dev
```

```
$sudo mount --bind /proc /media/sda1/proc
```